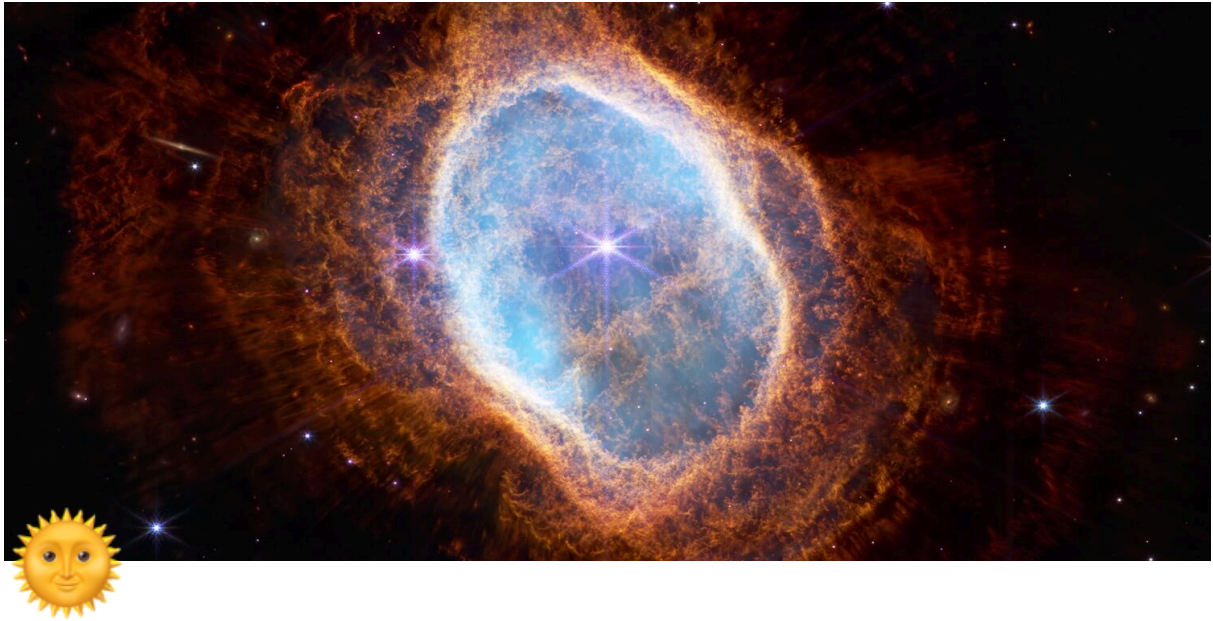




Purusha and Prakriti

Pantajali's Yoga Sutra

*"yogena chittasya padena vacham
malam sharirasya cha vaidyakena
yo'pakarottamam pravaram muninam
patanjalin pranjaliranato'smi"*

According to the Samkya school, the universe is divided into two parts, the Purusha and the Prakriti.

Purusa can be translated as "soul, pure consciousness or one's True Self". Kapil's theory describes Purusa according to 3 properties.

The 3 properties of Purusha

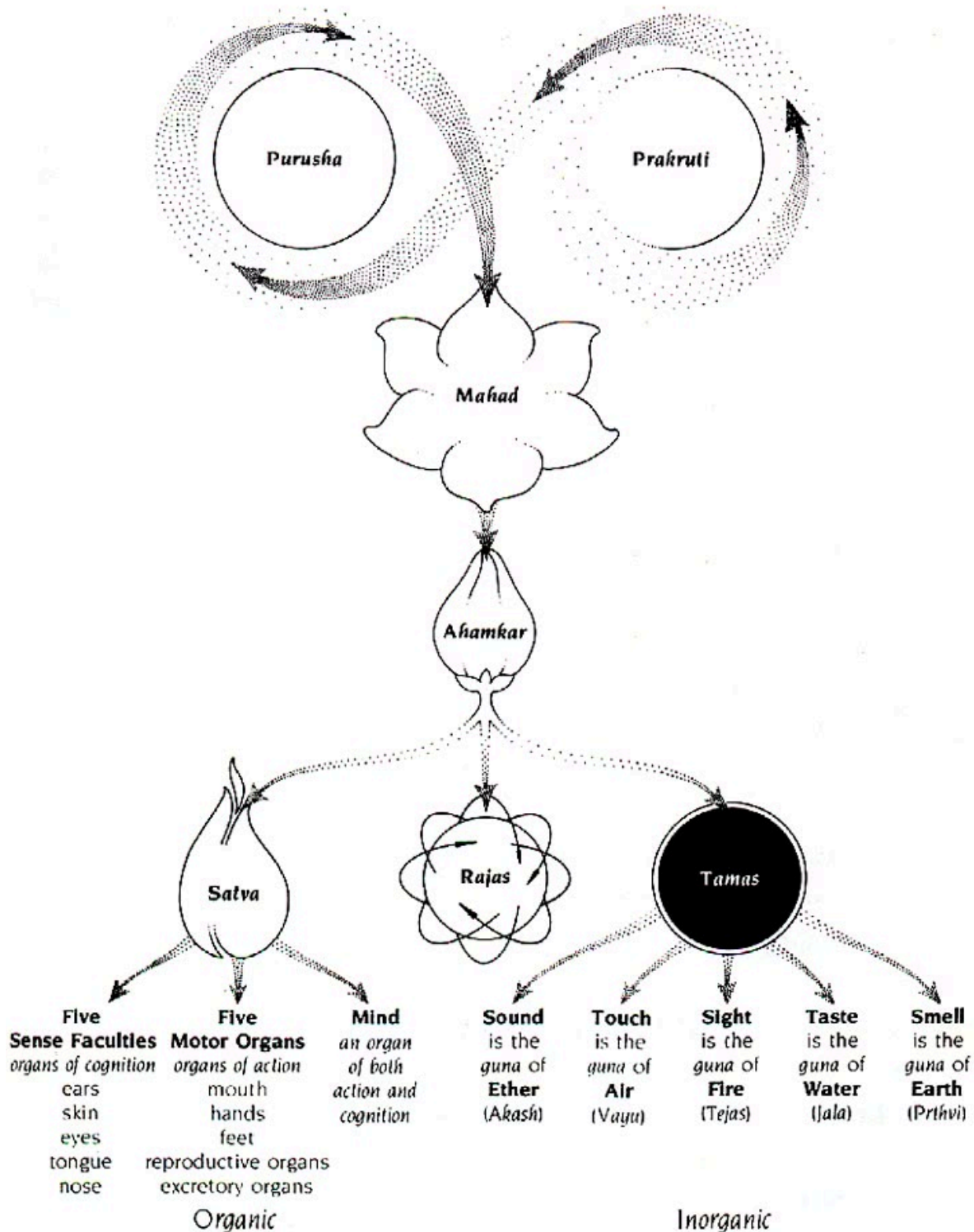
1. Purusa is **eternal (sat)**: it cannot **be destroyed** and is **immortal**. This also implies that it is **unalterable: nothing can alter** Purusa's nature. The elements of Pakriti (nature) in no way affect Purusa.
2. Purusa is **the observer (cit)**: purusa is a spectator Prakriti's experience.
3. Purusa is **blessed (ananda)**: Purusa is **constantly in a state of happiness**.

Nature or Prakriti

Prakriti or "Nature" refers to everything that does not belong to Purusa. It is all physical manifestations of our universe.

Samkhya Philosophy of Creation

Purusha is unmanifested, formless, passive, beyond attributes, beyond cause and effect, space and time. **Purusha** is Pure Existence. **Prakruti** is the creative force of action, the source of form, manifestation, attributes and nature. **Mahad** is the Cosmic Intelligence or *Buddhi*. **Ahamkar** is ego, the sense of "I am." **Satva** is stability, pure aspect, awakening, essence and light. **Rajas** is dynamic movement. **Tamas** is static. It is potential energy, inertia, darkness, ignorance and matter.



Prakriti therefore encompasses **all physical manifestations**, implying that our mind/spirit is also part of Prakriti. **Meditation** is a means of attaining Purusa by **overcoming** the elements of Prakriti. This is why **meditation** is said to transcend body and mind...

When we achieve something very arduous that has taken us a lot of work and effort, we feel exhilarated. This feeling is **due to a connection** with the Purusa.

It is this Union with the Purusa that every yogi seeks.

The Trigunas

These are the 3 fundamental energies that make up all the other elements of Prakriti. So a table is made up of a braid of Trigunas and its spirit.

1. **Sattva - luminous energy**: this is a very powerful energy, but seems very calm.
2. **Rajas - dynamic energy**: an excess of this energy tends to make you too active.
3. **Tamas - static energy or inertia**: in excess of this energy we tend to be too active.

II.18 prakasa kriya sthiti sila, bhutendriyatmakam bhogapavargartham drisyam

"The material world manifests itself in immobility, activity or clarity. It is made up of natural elements and sensory organs. The reason for this manifestation is to enjoy it or to free oneself from it."

prakāsha : clarity, splendor, light

kriyā : activity, work, labor

sthiti : state, standstill, immobility

shīla : having qualities, characteristics

bhūta : creature, element

indriya : sense organs

ātmaka : belonging to, composed of

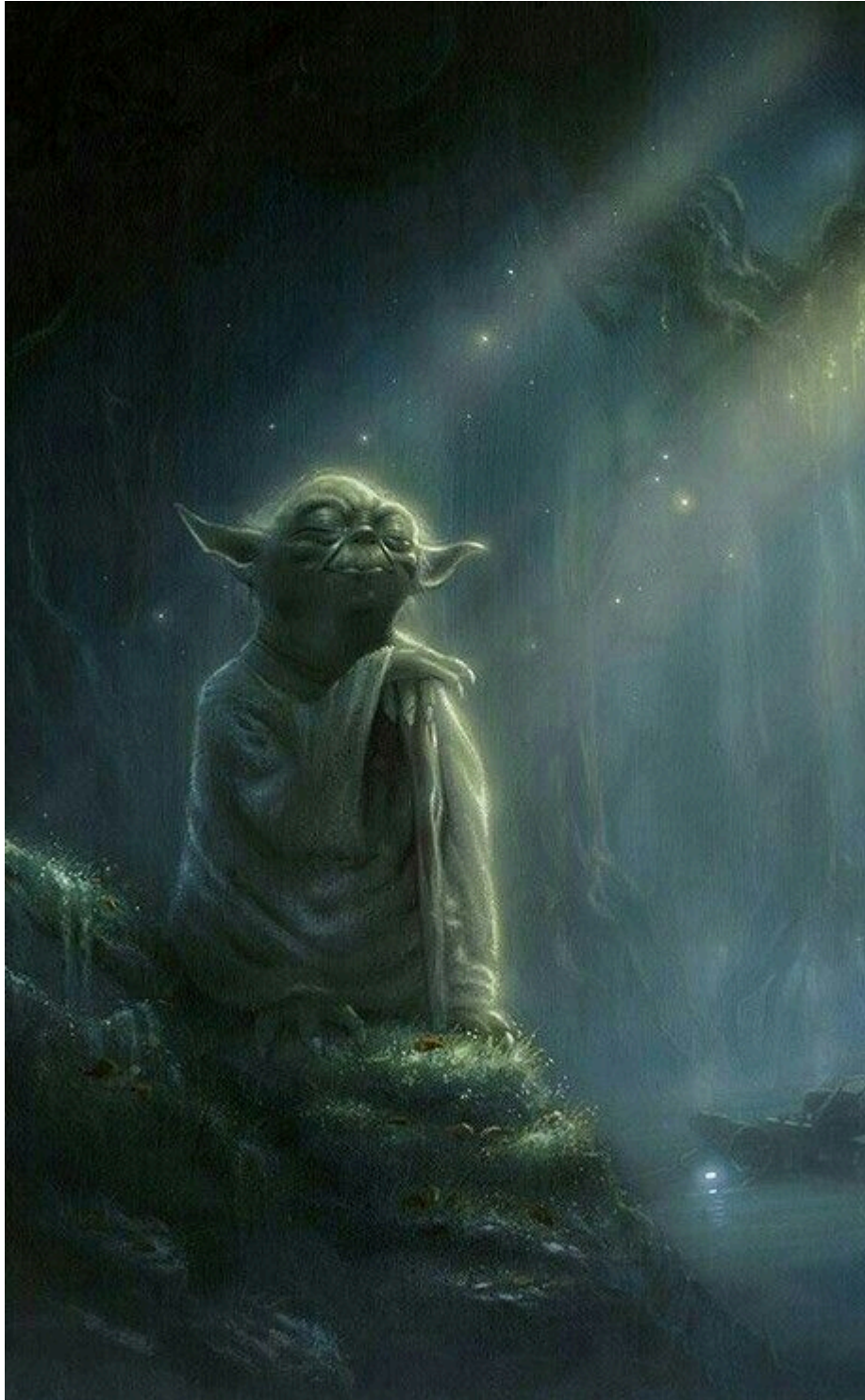
bhoga : enjoyment, use, perception

apavarga: bliss, final deliverance

artha: purpose, cause, motive

drishya: what is seen, the material manifested world

From this sutra we understand that Prakriti is linked to the notion of **Drishya** (what is seen, the manifested world, the spectacle) as opposed to **Purusa**, which is linked to the notion of **Drashta** (he who sees, the observer, the spectator).



"Soul Purusha is , **The multiverse** Prakriti is, Yoga the **Union** between Purusha and Prakriti is, this Union the purpose of a Jedi is"